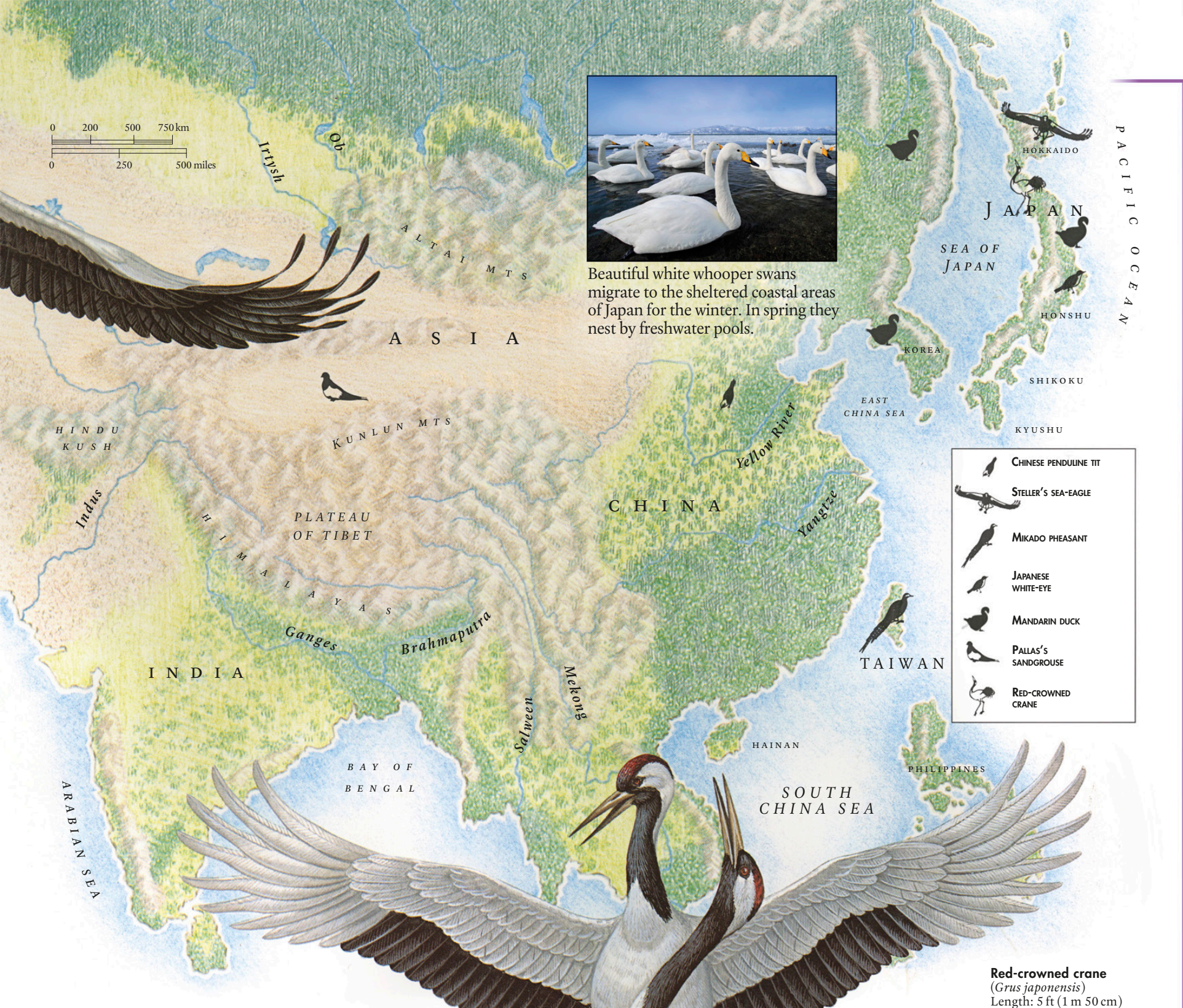


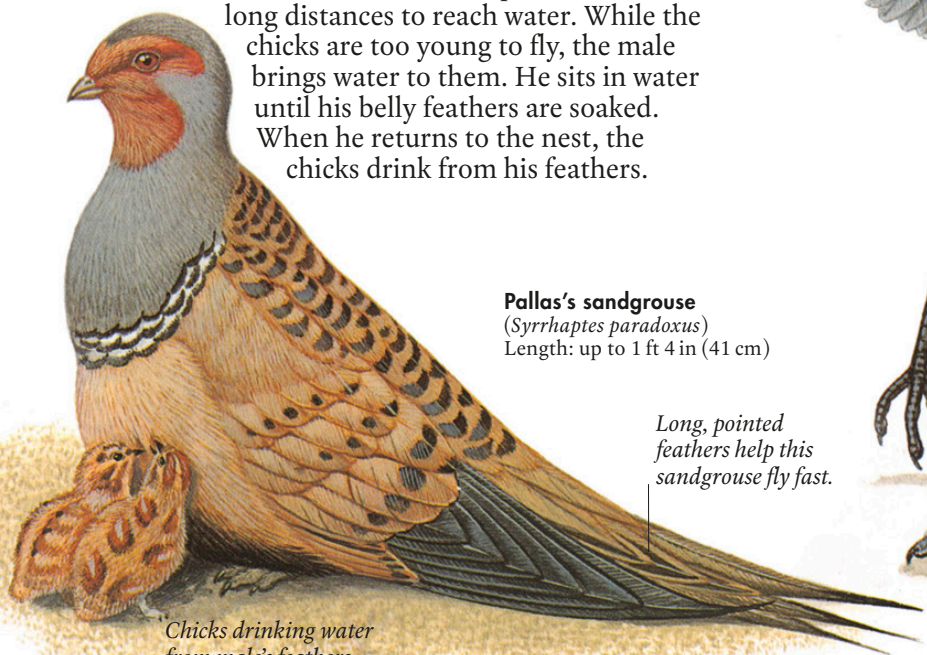


Beautiful white whooper swans migrate to the sheltered coastal areas of Japan for the winter. In spring they nest by freshwater pools.

-  CHINESE PENDULINE TIT
-  STELLER'S SEA-EAGLE
-  MIKADO PHEASANT
-  JAPANESE WHITE-EYE
-  MANDARIN DUCK
-  PALLAS'S SANDGROUSE
-  RED-CROWNED CRANE

Pallas's sandgrouse

This sandgrouse lives in the dry deserts and grasslands of northern China and central Asia. It feeds on the seeds and shoots of plants, and flies long distances to reach water. While the chicks are too young to fly, the male brings water to them. He sits in water until his belly feathers are soaked. When he returns to the nest, the chicks drink from his feathers.



Pallas's sandgrouse
(*Syrrhaptes paradoxus*)
Length: up to 1 ft 4 in (41 cm)

Long, pointed feathers help this sandgrouse fly fast.

Chicks drinking water from male's feathers.

Red-crowned crane
(*Grus japonensis*)
Length: 5 ft (1 m 50 cm)

A pair of cranes dance during courtship.



Red-crowned crane

Red-crowned cranes perform a spectacular courtship dance that involves leaping, bowing, and flapping their wings. They may even throw feathers or stones into the air. The dance helps a pair of birds form a strong partnership. Cranes usually stay with the same mate all their lives and rarely dance once they have chosen a partner. Each pair defends a large breeding territory and calls loudly to tell other cranes to keep out.